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Business Process Procedure Overview
Add*one user instructions

→ **Forecast Alignment in PDP: [3.2.2.3 - Forecast Alignment in PDP - Concept, Content and Tracking - PT Demand Management - Docupe...](#)**

The concept of the PDP & PIM needs explained

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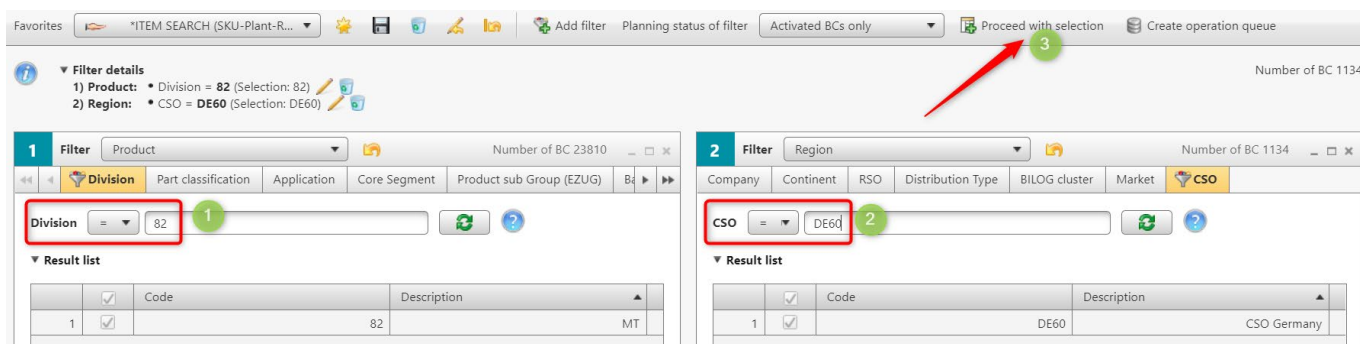
First please access the link: [Forecast Alignment Video](#) and check out the video with one example on how to work with the Forecast Alignment and its drill down in **PDP31**.

Then please check below for another example with some other analysis and a step-by-step suggestion:

First of all, identify the time **periods** of where your highest/biggest deviations are:

The Demand Planner needs to check if the key figure **Final Demand** in the PDP system (total SP1 + total SP2 + total SP3), on the corresponding aggregated level (e.g.: CSO), is in line with the Rolling Sales Forecast previously aligned in the last S&OP.

E.g.: a Demand Planner responsible for the demand plan for the BU Measuring Tools (MT), CSO DE60, needs to first check the current demand plan that is in the PDP system on that CSO level, following the steps showed in the picture below (numbers **1-3**):



The screenshot shows the SAP PDP31 interface. At the top, there's a toolbar with buttons like 'Add filter', 'Planning status of filter', 'Activated BCs only', 'Proceed with selection' (highlighted with a red arrow and number 3), and 'Create operation queue'. Below this, the 'Filter details' section shows: 1) Product: Division = 82 (Selection: 82), 2) Region: CSO = DE60 (Selection: DE60). The main area is divided into two panels. The left panel, titled '1 Filter Product', shows a filter for 'Division' set to '82' (highlighted with a red box and number 1). Below it, the 'Result list' shows a table with columns 'Code' and 'Description', containing one row with '82' and 'MT'. The right panel, titled '2 Filter Region', shows a filter for 'CSO' set to 'DE60' (highlighted with a red box and number 2). Below it, the 'Result list' shows a table with columns 'Code' and 'Description', containing one row with 'DE60' and 'CSO Germany'.

After proceeding with the selection, it is necessary to select the time frame desired for this first level of analysis.

In this example, let us assume that you are in April 2021 and that the BU MT has already previously defined their short-term demand planning horizon as 0-6 months.

Therefore, the time frame for the future needs to be selected as October 2021 at least (as shown in the number **5** in the picture below (you can also go further into the future if you desire).

For the number **4**, you can select the current month or any other month you would like from the past (in this case, it was chosen November 2020).

Be reminded: always use the "Value" view, as the comparison against Rolling Sales Forecast will always be possible in values.

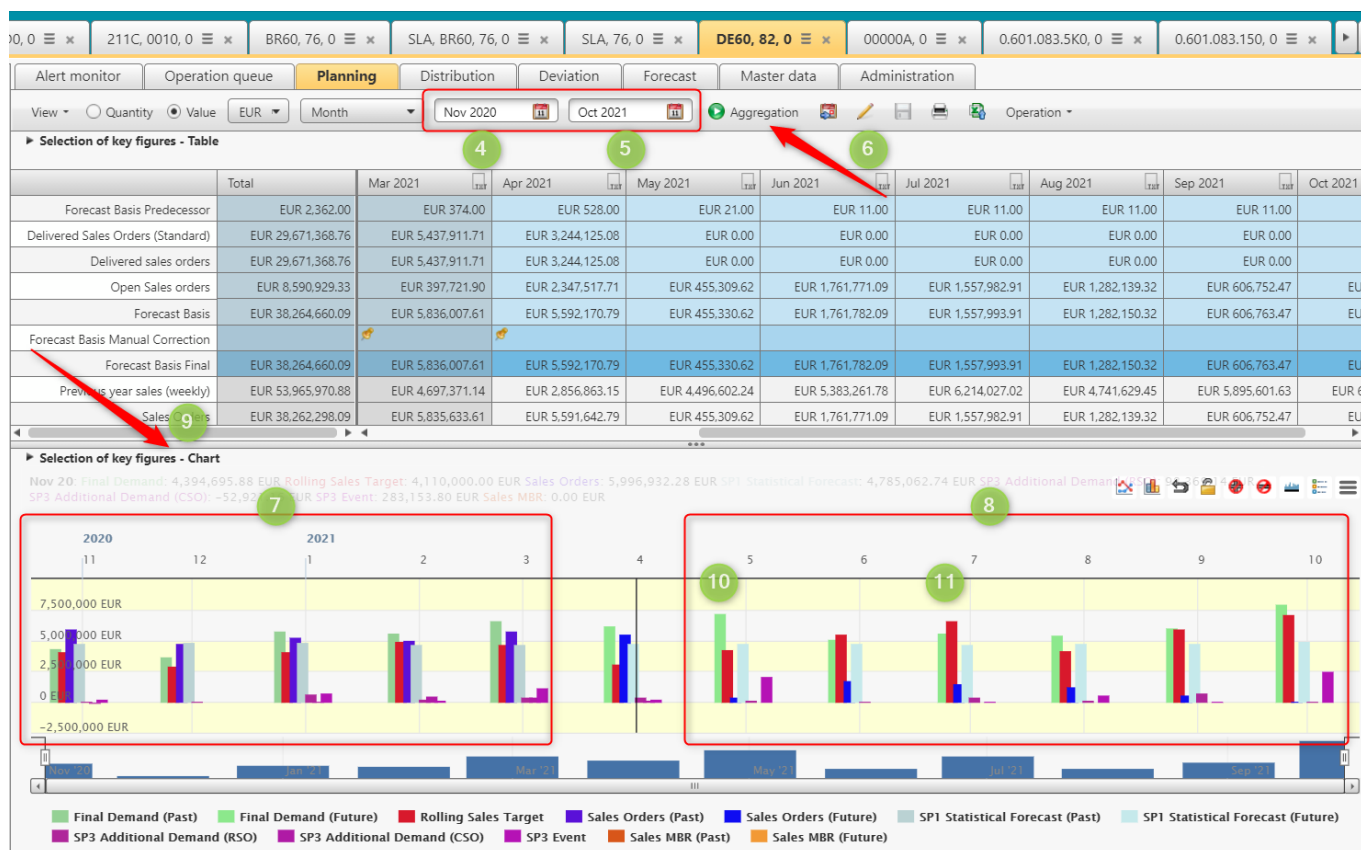
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Please note that the selected months are also shown in a graphic, easier and more comprehensive way (numbers **7** and **8**), where you can compare different key figures.

You can check all the available key figures by going to number **9** and choosing the ones you think are relevant for your analysis.

In this aggregated level (e.g.:CSO), the Demand Planner needs to check for possible deviations once a week only for the current month (e.g.: April) and for the next next one (e.g.: May), as stated in the Chapter 3.2.1 of the Demand Planning Procedure ([LINK](#)).

For the other months ahead, checking once a month should be enough when doing the monthly preparation for the S&OP meetings.



In the number **10** of the picture above (May 2021), you can see a significant deviation between the Final Demand (green bar) and the Rolling Sales Forecast (red bar).

However, checking the historical sales orders since November 2020, in all months the Sales Orders (blue bar) were higher than the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF).

This could be the case where the Demand Planner should double check it with the RMM/KAM to see how feasible an increase in the Rolling Sales Forecast would be.

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This way, the system would show a more realistic sales target and make it closer to the real sales, reducing the shown deviation.

However, for the purpose of exercising, let us consider a different scenario:

Imagine that for the past months the Final Demand and the RSF were very well aligned but May (number **10**) was showing this high deviation where the Final Demand is 67% higher than the RSF. It could be assumed that the Final Demand was highly overestimated or the RSF was highly underestimated.

Whichever would be the case, the Demand Planner should double check it with the RMM/KAM and together, align on the correct number and make the necessary changes. If the RSF figure was correct and the Final Demand was not adapted accordingly, there would be a high chance for a significant overstock level increase, which would incur in extra unnecessary costs to the Organization.

The number **11** on the same picture above (July 2021) shows us the opposite scenario: the RSF is above the Final Demand. The Demand Planner and the RMM/KAM should talk to each other and get into an alignment.

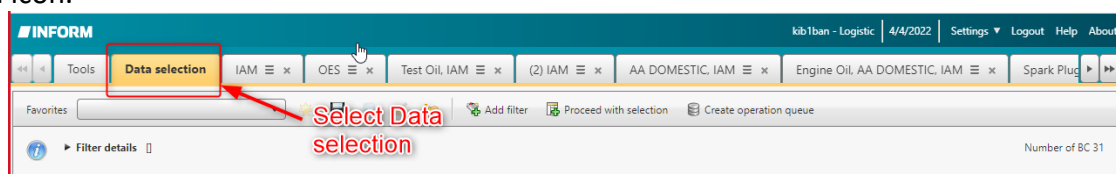
If the RSF is correct and the Final Demand is not adapted accordingly, there is a high chance for a stock-out situation, a negative impact on the CSL1 (Customer Service Level) and ultimately possible sales losses.

Those were simple examples where it clearly shows not only why Logistics and Sales/Marketing must be very well aligned in a weekly/monthly basis, but also the impacts and negative consequences that could come up when an alignment is neglected or not frequently done.

For more details, please check [HERE](#).

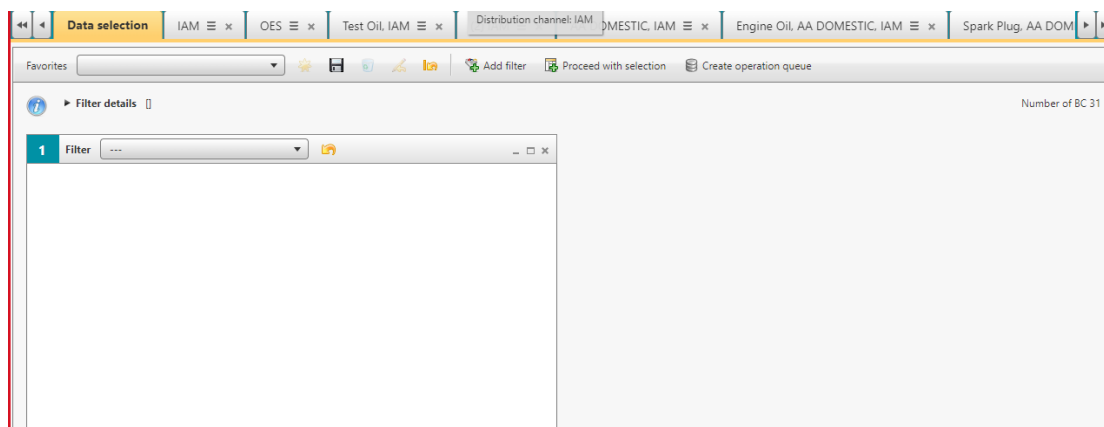
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Step 1: Below picture is home page for add*one. Highlighted selection is the toolbox. Select data selection icon.

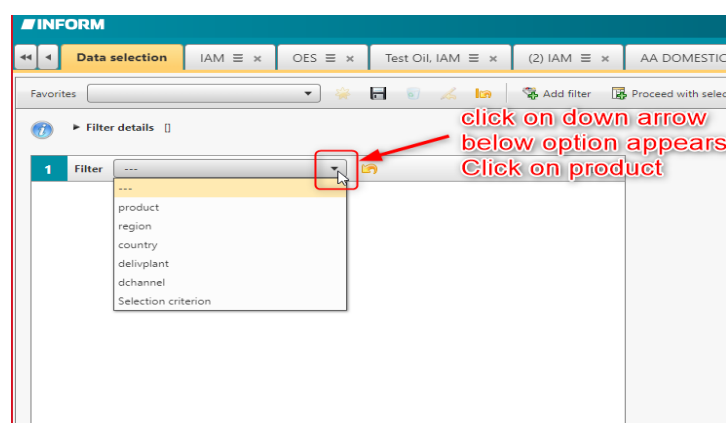


Step 2: Click on data selection, below option appears

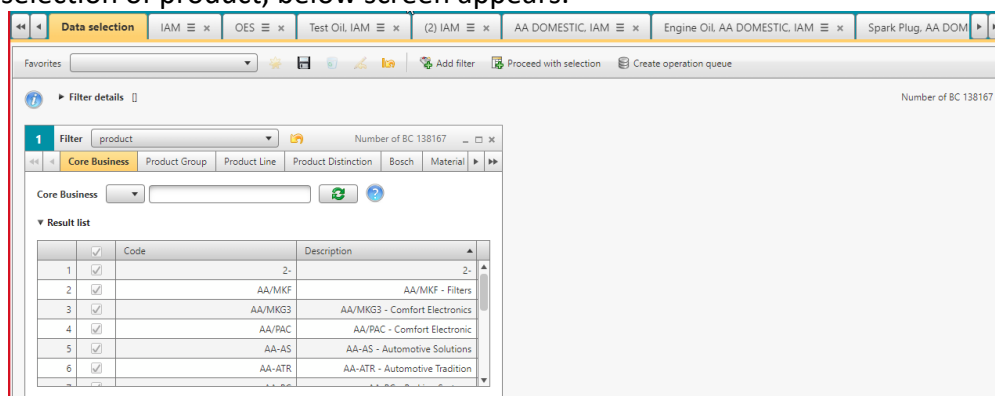
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Step 3: Click on down arrow, below option appears. Select the required option by click on them. Click on product.

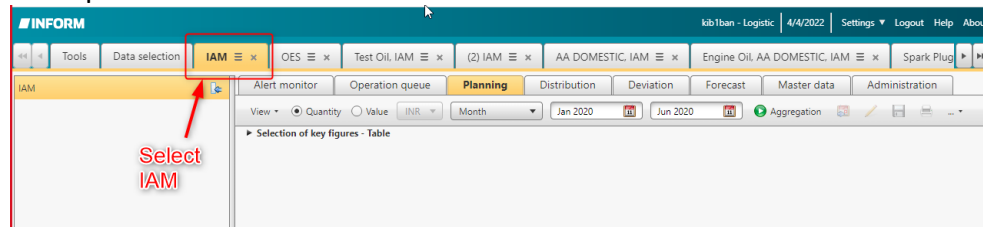


Step 4: After selection of product, below screen appears.

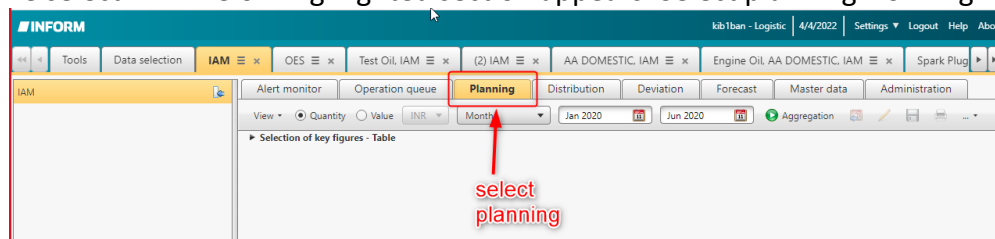


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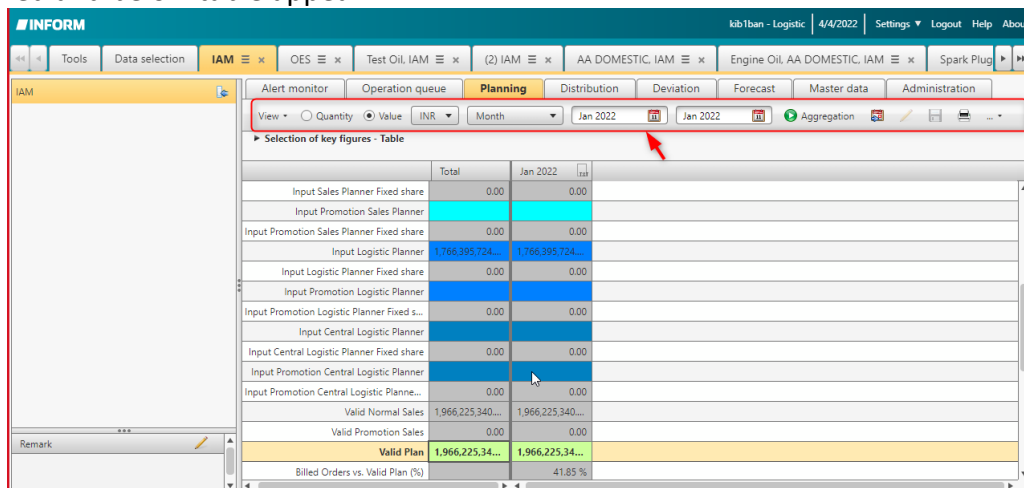
Step 5: Select IAM option from main toolbox.



Step 6: Once we select IAM. Below highlighted section appears. Select planning from highlighted area.



Step 7: After selection of planning below screen appears. In view select value and next to value select month required and below table appear.

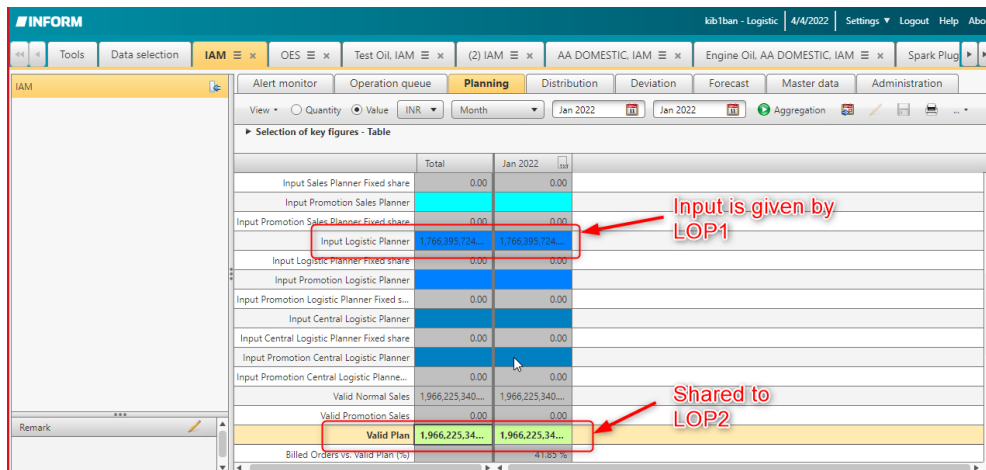


	Total	Jan 2022	Jan 2022
Input Sales Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00	
Input Promotion Sales Planner			
Input Promotion Sales Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00	
Input Logistic Planner	1,766,395,724...	1,766,395,724...	
Input Logistic Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00	
Input Promotion Logistic Planner			
Input Promotion Logistic Planner Fixed s...	0.00	0.00	
Input Central Logistic Planner			
Input Central Logistic Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00	
Input Promotion Central Logistic Planner			
Input Promotion Central Logistic Planne...	0.00	0.00	
Valid Normal Sales	1,966,225,340...	1,966,225,340...	
Valid Promotion Sales	0.00	0.00	
Valid Plan	1,966,225,34...	1,966,225,34...	
Billed Orders vs. Valid Plan (%)		41.85 %	

Step 8: Once we select required option and run it, below table appears. The Input logistic planner row is given by LOG1.

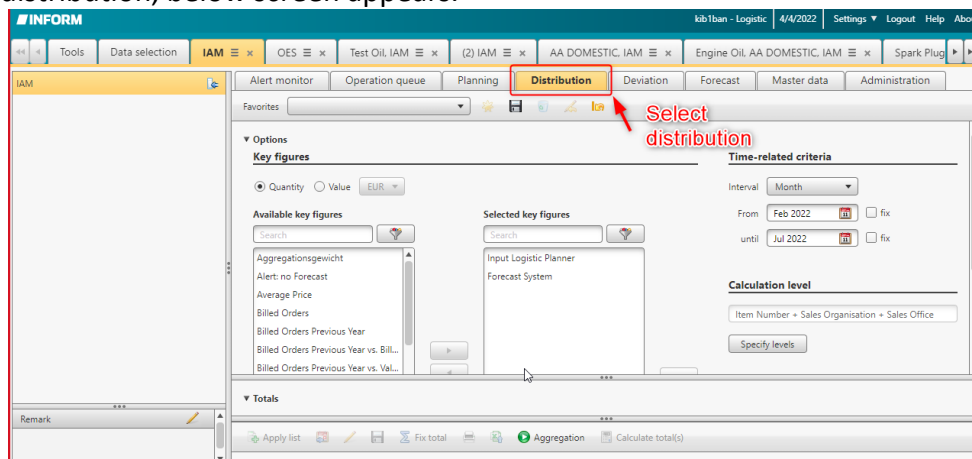
The valid plan will be shared to LOG2 team for source planning.

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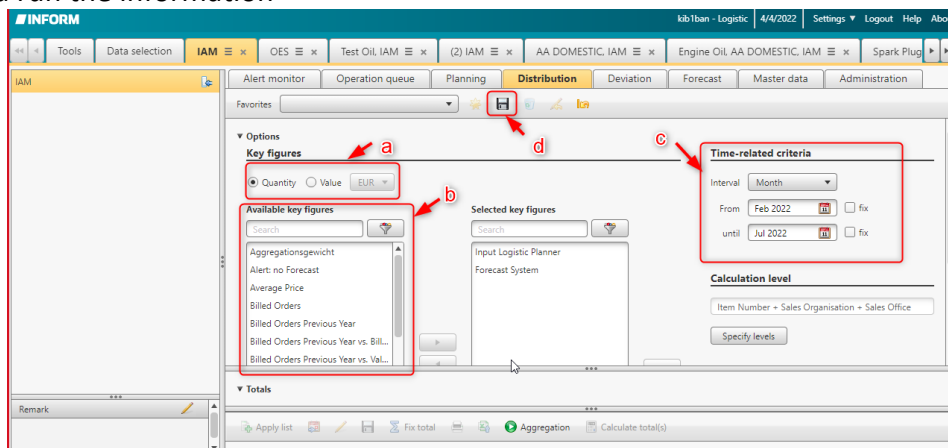


	Total	Jan 2022
Input Sales Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00
Input Promotion Sales Planner		
Input Promotion Sales Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00
Input Logistic Planner	1,766,395,724...	1,766,395,724...
Input Logistic Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00
Input Promotion Logistic Planner		
Input Promotion Logistic Planner Fixed s...	0.00	0.00
Input Central Logistic Planner		
Input Central Logistic Planner Fixed share	0.00	0.00
Input Promotion Central Logistic Planner		
Input Promotion Central Logistic Planne...	0.00	0.00
Valid Normal Sales	1,966,225,340...	1,966,225,340...
Valid Promotion Sales	0.00	0.00
Valid Plan	1,966,225,34...	1,966,225,34...
Billed Orders vs. Valid Plan (%)		41.85 %

Step 9: Select distribution, below screen appears.

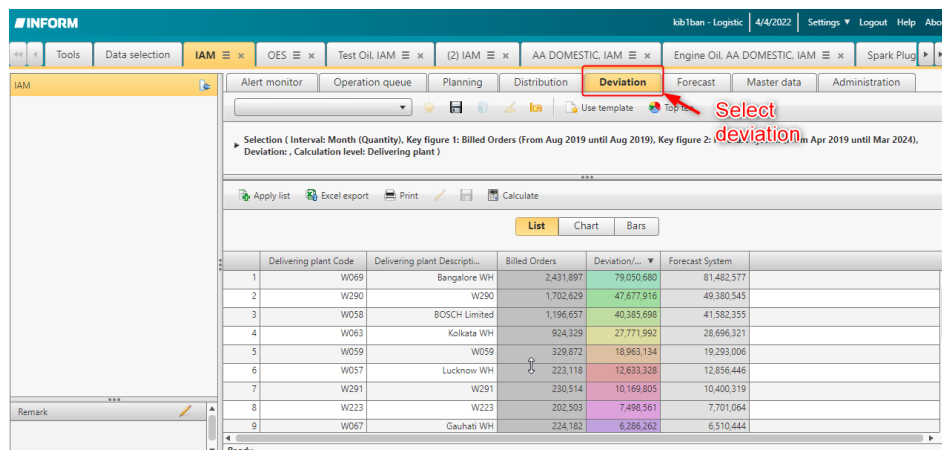


- Step 10:** a) select value
b) select required key figure from available options
c) select the required time interval
d) click and run the information

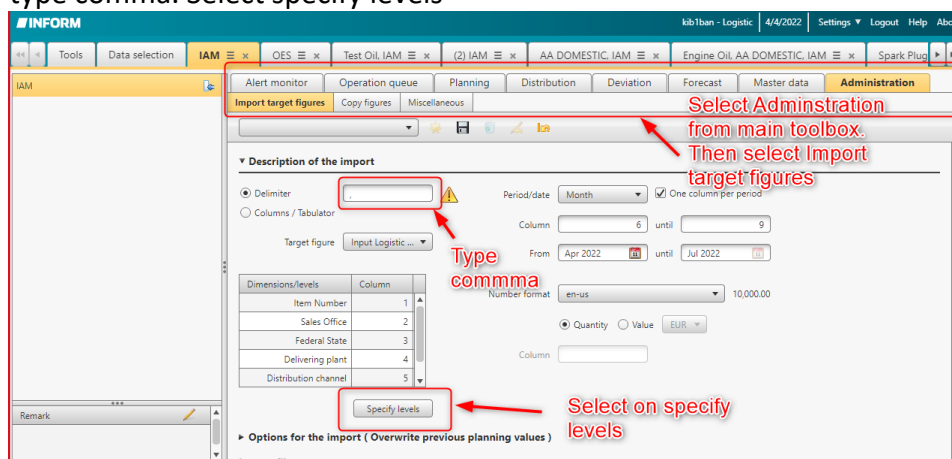


Step 11: Select deviation option below screen appears. This table provides information about deviation from forecast to billed orders for each warehouse.

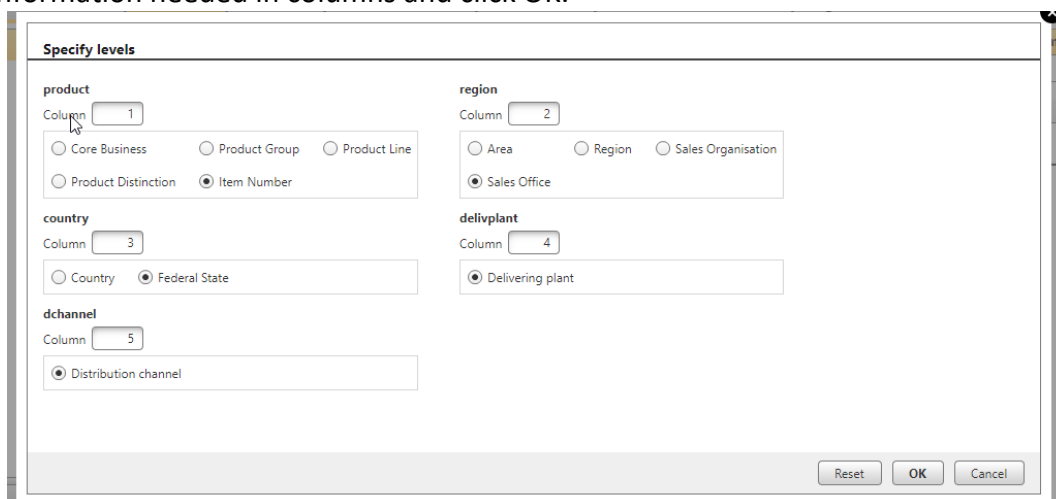
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Step 12: Select administration from main toolbox. Then select import target figures.
In delimiter type comma. Select specify levels



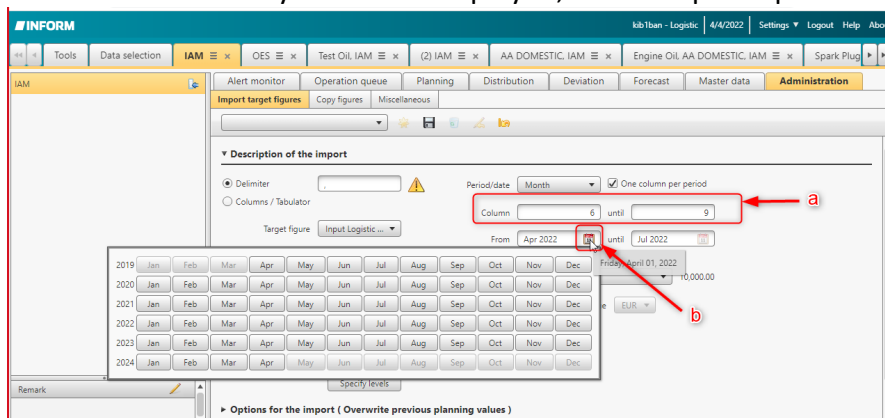
Step 13: After selecting specify level below screen appears.
Select information needed in columns and click OK.



Step 14:

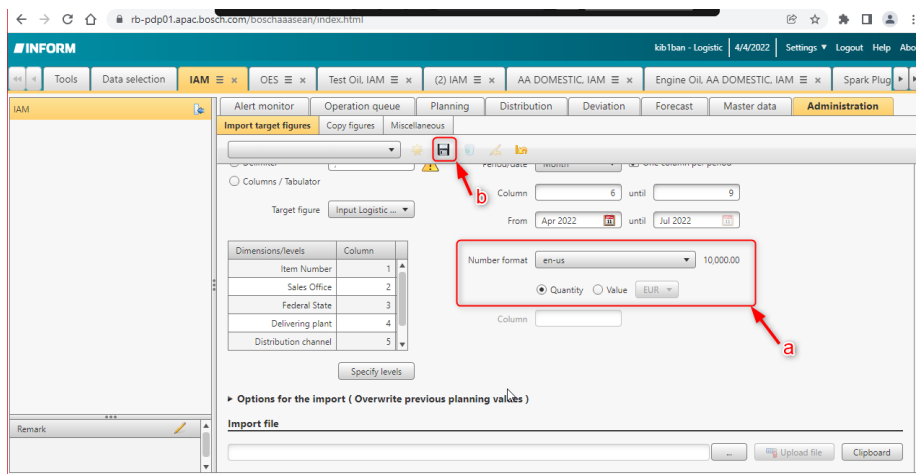
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- a) The month will be displayed from column 6 to 9. Because tentative forecast will be done for 1+3 months.
- b) Select small calendar he month and year will be displayed, select required period of time.

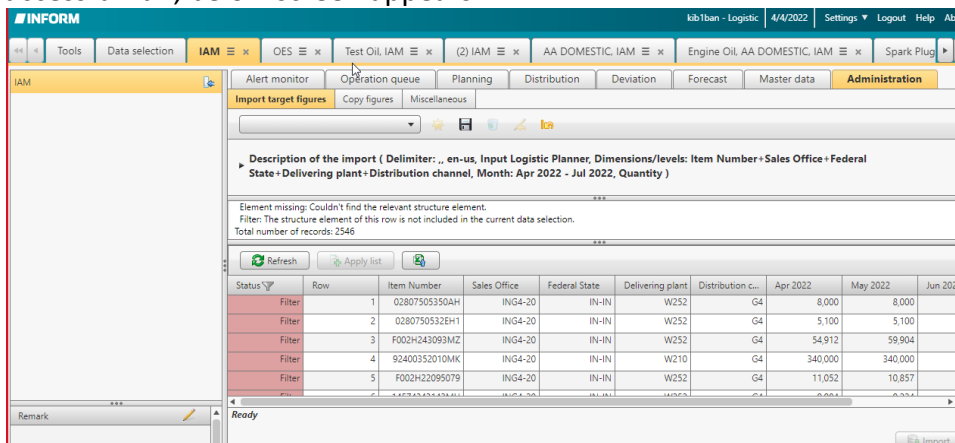


Step 15:

- a) Select number format value or quantity as per requirement.
- b) Select run.



Step 16: After successful run, below screen appears.



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Report interpretations

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS and ANSWERS: -

1. What is the purpose of Forecast Alignment in PDP?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment in PDP ensures that the Final Demand in PDP is aligned with the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF) agreed during the S&OP process.

Business Purpose:

- Identify deviations between Final Demand and RSF
- Maintain alignment between Logistics and Sales/Marketing
- Improve demand planning accuracy
- Reduce overstock and stock-out risks

The Demand Planner is responsible for regularly checking and aligning Final Demand with the agreed Rolling Sales Forecast.

2. What should a Demand Planner verify during Forecast Alignment?

Answer:

The Demand Planner must verify whether the PDP Final Demand is aligned with the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF) at the relevant aggregation level (e.g., CSO).

The Final Demand consists of:

- SP1
- SP2
- SP3

Business Objective:

- Detect significant deviations
- Validate forecast assumptions
- Align planning with market expectations

3. How often should Forecast Alignment be reviewed?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment should be reviewed:

For Current Month and Next Month:

- Once per week

For Future Months:

- Once per month during S&OP preparation

This review frequency helps identify planning deviations early while maintaining alignment between Logistics and Sales.

4. Why should the Value View be used in Add*one Forecast Alignment?

Answer:

INTERNAL

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The Value View should be used because comparison against the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF) is performed in values.

Business Purpose:

- Enable direct comparison between Final Demand and RSF
- Support deviation analysis
- Improve forecast validation accuracy

5. What should be done when Final Demand is significantly higher than RSF?

Answer:

When Final Demand is significantly higher than RSF:

- The Demand Planner should review the deviation
- The Demand Planner should discuss the deviation with the RMM/KAM
- Both parties should align on the correct demand value
- Necessary planning adjustments should be made

If not aligned, there is a risk that demand may be overestimated.

6. What is the business risk when Final Demand is higher than RSF and not corrected?

Answer:

If Final Demand is higher than RSF and not corrected:

- Inventory may be planned above actual market demand
- Overstock levels may increase
- Additional inventory carrying costs may occur

Business Impact:

- Increased inventory investment
- Higher stock holding costs
- Reduced planning efficiency

This risk is explicitly described in the Forecast Alignment example.

7. What is the business risk when RSF is higher than Final Demand and not corrected?

Answer:

If RSF is higher than Final Demand and no alignment is performed:

- Demand may be underestimated in planning
- Stock-out situations may occur
- CSL1 (Customer Service Level) may be negatively impacted
- Potential sales losses may occur

Business Impact:

- Reduced product availability
- Customer service degradation
- Lost revenue opportunities

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8. Why is alignment between Logistics and Sales/Marketing important?

Answer:

Alignment between Logistics and Sales/Marketing ensures that Final Demand and Rolling Sales Forecast remain synchronized.

Benefits:

- Reduces planning deviations
- Minimizes overstock risk
- Minimizes stock-out risk
- Supports Customer Service Level performance
- Improves demand planning accuracy

The document highlights regular weekly and monthly alignment as a critical planning activity.

9. What is the role of LOG1 in Add*one Planning?

Answer:

LOG1 is responsible for entering the logistics planning input in Add*one.

Business Role:

- Create and maintain the logistics plan
- Generate a valid planning proposal
- Support demand planning activities

The valid plan is subsequently shared with LOG2 for source planning activities.

10. What is the role of LOG2 in Add*one Planning?

Answer:

LOG2 receives the validated planning information from LOG1.

Business Role:

- Use the validated logistics plan for source planning
- Support supply planning activities based on approved demand inputs

The planning flow described in the document is:

LOG1 Planning Input → Valid Plan → LOG2 Source Planning

11. What information does the Deviation view provide?

Answer:

The Deviation view provides information about the deviation between forecast and billed orders for each warehouse.

Business Purpose:

- Measure forecast accuracy
- Identify planning deviations
- Support demand planning reviews
- Improve forecast alignment activities

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12. What is the purpose of importing target figures in Add*one?

Answer:

Import Target Figures allows planners to upload planning targets into Add*one for forecasting and planning activities.

The process includes:

- Selecting Import Target Figures
- Defining levels
- Selecting required planning dimensions
- Choosing planning periods
- Running the import

This supports demand planning and forecast preparation activities.

13. What planning horizon is referenced in the target figure upload process?

Answer:

The target figure upload process supports a tentative forecast horizon of 1+3 months.

During the upload process:

- Forecast months are displayed in columns 6 to 9
- The planner selects the required planning period
- Forecast values are loaded for planning activities

14. What happens if Forecast Alignment is neglected?

Answer:

If Forecast Alignment is neglected:

- Deviations between Final Demand and RSF increase
- Overstock risk increases
- Stock-out risk increases
- CSL1 performance may be negatively impacted
- Sales opportunities may be lost

The document highlights Forecast Alignment as a necessary activity to maintain planning accuracy and operational performance.

15. What is Final Demand in PDP?

Answer:

Final Demand is the key figure used by the Demand Planner in PDP.

Final Demand consists of:

- Total SP1
- Total SP2
- Total SP3

It is compared against the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF) during Forecast Alignment activities.

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16. What is the objective of comparing Final Demand with RSF?

Answer:

The objective is to identify planning deviations and ensure demand plans remain aligned with sales expectations agreed during S&OP.

This helps reduce:

- Overstock risk
- Stock-out risk
- Forecast inaccuracies

17. Who participates in Forecast Alignment discussions?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment requires collaboration between:

- Demand Planner
- RMM
- KAM

These stakeholders review significant deviations and align on the correct planning figures.

18. When should a Demand Planner investigate deviations?

Answer:

A Demand Planner should investigate deviations whenever there is a significant difference between:

- Final Demand
- Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF)

The deviation should be reviewed with RMM/KAM before planning decisions are finalized.

19. Why is weekly forecast alignment required?

Answer:

Weekly forecast alignment helps detect demand deviations early and prevents planning misalignment between Logistics and Sales.

Benefits include:

- Better forecast accuracy
- Reduced inventory risk
- Improved service performance

20. How can poor forecast alignment lead to overstock?

Answer:

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If Final Demand remains higher than the realistic market forecast:

Final Demand → Excess planning quantities → Overstock → Increased inventory costs

The document explicitly identifies overstock as a potential consequence of poor forecast alignment.

21. How can poor forecast alignment lead to stock-outs?

Answer:

If Final Demand remains lower than actual market demand:

Insufficient planning → Stock shortage → CSL impact → Potential sales loss

The document explicitly highlights stock-out risk when RSF and Final Demand are not aligned.

22. What is the relationship between Forecast Alignment and CSL?

Answer:

Poor Forecast Alignment can result in stock shortages.

Stock shortages negatively impact:

- CSL1 (Customer Service Level)
- Product availability
- Sales performance

23. What is the purpose of the Distribution view in Add*one?

Answer:

The Distribution view allows planners to analyze selected key figures across a chosen time interval.

Users can:

- Select Value view
- Select key figures
- Define time intervals
- Run analysis

24. What is the purpose of Deviation analysis in Add*one?

Answer:

Deviation analysis compares forecast values against billed orders for each warehouse.

Business Purpose:

- Identify planning inaccuracies
- Monitor forecast performance
- Support forecast improvement activities

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25. What information is required when importing target figures?

Answer:

During target figure import:

- Define levels
- Select planning dimensions
- Select planning period
- Choose value or quantity format
- Run the upload

26. Why is forecast accuracy important in Add*one planning?

Answer:

Forecast accuracy supports:

- Correct inventory planning
- Better supply planning
- Reduced overstock risk
- Reduced stock-out risk
- Improved customer service performance

27. How does Forecast Alignment support S&OP?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment ensures PDP demand figures remain aligned with the Rolling Sales Forecast agreed during S&OP.

This creates consistency between:

- Sales expectations
- Demand planning
- Supply planning

28. What happens after LOG1 creates a valid plan?

Answer:

After LOG1 creates a valid plan:

- The plan is validated
- The information is shared with LOG2
- LOG2 uses the plan for source planning activities

29. Why is collaboration between Logistics and Sales important?

Answer:

Collaboration ensures planning figures reflect actual market expectations.

Without alignment:

- Overstock risk increases
- Stock-out risk increases

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- CSL may deteriorate
- Sales opportunities may be lost

30. What is the operational purpose of Add*one?

Answer:

Add*one supports:

- Demand planning
- Forecast alignment
- Deviation monitoring
- Distribution analysis
- Target figure management

The tool helps maintain alignment between planning and market demand.

31. Why is Forecast Alignment performed before planning decisions are finalized?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment ensures that PDP Final Demand reflects the latest market expectations captured in the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF).

Business Purpose:

- Reduce planning deviations
- Improve forecast reliability
- Prevent overstock and stock-out situations
- Align Logistics and Sales before execution

32. Why should Final Demand and RSF not diverge significantly?

Answer:

Significant deviations between Final Demand and RSF indicate misalignment between planning assumptions and market expectations.

Potential impacts:

- Excess inventory
- Stock shortages
- Reduced planning accuracy
- Service level risks

33. How does Forecast Alignment improve inventory planning?

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Answer:

Forecast Alignment helps ensure inventory plans are based on agreed demand expectations.

Benefits:

- Better inventory coverage
- Lower excess stock risk
- Lower stock-out risk
- Improved inventory utilization

34. What is the role of deviation analysis in demand planning?

Answer:

Deviation analysis identifies differences between forecasted demand and actual billed orders.

Business Purpose:

- Monitor forecast accuracy
- Detect planning gaps
- Support forecast improvement
- Improve future planning decisions

35. Why should planners monitor billed orders versus forecast?

Answer:

Comparing billed orders against forecast helps determine whether demand assumptions are accurate.

Benefits:

- Early identification of forecast errors
- Better demand visibility
- Improved planning quality

36. How does inaccurate forecasting impact supply planning?

Answer:

Inaccurate forecasting can result in:

- Excess inventory when demand is overestimated
- Stock shortages when demand is underestimated
- Inefficient supply planning decisions

Accurate forecasts support better supply planning execution.

37. What is the business value of maintaining an agreed forecast?

Answer:

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An agreed forecast provides a common planning baseline for Sales, Marketing, Logistics, and Supply Planning.

Benefits:

- Consistent planning assumptions
- Improved coordination
- Reduced planning conflicts
- Better operational execution

38. Why is collaboration between Demand Planner and RMM/KAM necessary?

Answer:

Demand Planner, RMM, and KAM collaborate to validate demand assumptions and resolve forecast deviations.

This ensures planning decisions reflect both:

- Market expectations
- Operational planning requirements

39. What can happen if planning decisions are made without forecast validation?

Answer:

Without forecast validation:

- Demand assumptions may be inaccurate
- Inventory planning may become unreliable
- Overstock and stock-out risks increase
- Service performance may be affected

40. How does Add*one support demand planning activities?

Answer:

Add*one supports demand planning through:

- Forecast Alignment
- Distribution Analysis
- Deviation Monitoring
- Target Figure Management
- Planning Data Maintenance

These functions help planners maintain accurate demand plans.

41. Why is Value View important during forecast comparison?

Answer:

Value View enables planners to compare Final Demand with the Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF) using the same measurement basis.

This improves:

- Forecast validation
- Deviation analysis

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- Planning consistency

42. What is the objective of maintaining a valid plan before LOG2 planning?

Answer:

A valid plan ensures that source planning is based on approved and aligned demand assumptions.

Business Benefit:

- Better planning consistency
- Reduced planning errors
- Improved execution quality

43. What is the relationship between demand planning and customer service?

Answer:

Accurate demand planning supports product availability.

Benefits:

- Better stock availability
- Reduced stock shortages
- Improved customer service performance

Poor demand planning can negatively impact CSL.

44. How can forecasting errors affect inventory costs?

Answer:

Forecasting errors can create excess inventory or stock shortages.

Business Impact:

- Increased inventory carrying costs
- Additional operational costs
- Reduced inventory efficiency

45. Why is regular forecast review important?

Answer:

Regular forecast reviews help planners identify changes in demand patterns and correct planning assumptions early.

Benefits:

- Improved forecast quality
- Reduced planning deviations

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- Better inventory management

46. What is the operational flow from Forecast Alignment to Source Planning?

Answer:

Operational Flow:

Rolling Sales Forecast (RSF)

→ Forecast Alignment

→ Final Demand Validation

→ LOG1 Planning

→ Valid Plan Creation

→ LOG2 Source Planning

This ensures source planning is based on validated demand inputs.

47. How does Forecast Alignment support inventory optimization?

Answer:

Forecast Alignment improves demand accuracy by keeping Final Demand aligned with RSF.

Benefits:

- Reduced excess inventory
- Reduced stock shortages
- Improved inventory utilization
- Better planning efficiency

48. Why should demand deviations be investigated promptly?

Answer:

Prompt investigation helps prevent planning errors from propagating into inventory and supply plans.

Benefits:

- Faster issue resolution
- Improved forecast quality
- Better planning decisions